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Waveform for metering fuel into a fuel injector

Abstract

A multi-fuel injection system and method for generating combustion signals and metering signals for fuel injectors are provided. A first fuel and a second fuel may be received. A combustion signal may be generated to cause a fuel injector to perform fuel injection to inject at least one of the first fuel or the second fuel into a cylinder of an engine. A metering signal may be generated to cause the fuel injector to perform fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to fuel injectors, and, more particularly, to a system and method for generating combustion signals and metering signals for fuel injectors.

BACKGROUND

(2) Fuel injection systems typically include fuel injectors that each inject fuel for combustion in cylinders of an engine. An electronic control module (ECM) of the fuel injection system is configured to transmit signals to cause the fuel injector to perform fuel injection. Signals transmitted to solenoids of fuel injectors tend to generate heat. In some fuel injection systems, heat builds when fuel injector solenoids are energized for relatively long periods of time. Increased heat

can, in some circumstances impact performance of the fuel injector, cause increased wear, or even result in overheating.

(3) German Patent No. DE102007000070B4, issued on Mar. 23, 2017 (“the '070 Patent”), describes a pulse control system for fuel injection for an internal combustion engine that includes a solenoid valve connected to a controller which generates variable pulse lengths between the on phase and the off phase of the fuel supply cycle. The valve can be controlled sequentially with a mixture of a strong control mode and a smaller control mode. The '070 Patent does not describe a system and method for generating a combustion signal having a combustion waveform and a metering signal having a metering waveform.

(4) The system and method of the present disclosure may solve one or more of the problems set forth above and/or other problems in the art. The scope of the current disclosure, however, is defined by the attached claims, and not by the ability to solve any specific problem.

SUMMARY

(5) In one aspect, a method may include receiving, by a multi-fuel injection system, a first fuel; receiving, by the multi-fuel injection system, a second fuel; generating, by the multi-fuel injection system, a combustion signal to cause a fuel injector to perform fuel injection to inject at least one of the first fuel or the second fuel into a cylinder of an engine; and generating, by the multi-fuel injection system, a metering signal to cause the fuel injector to perform fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine, wherein the combustion signal includes a combustion waveform including at least one of a combustion keep-in section or a combustion hold-in section, wherein the metering signal includes a metering waveform including at least one of a metering keep-in section or a metering hold-in section, and wherein a duration of the metering keep-in section is different than a duration of the combustion keep-in section or an amplitude of the metering hold-in section is different than an amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.

(6) In one aspect, an electronic control module (ECM) may include a memory configured to store instructions; and one or more processors configured to execute the instructions to: generate a combustion signal to cause a fuel injector to perform fuel injection to inject at least one of a first fuel or a second fuel into a cylinder of an engine; and generate a metering signal to cause the fuel injector to perform fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine, wherein the combustion signal includes a combustion waveform including at least one of a combustion keep-in section or a combustion hold-in section, wherein the metering signal includes a metering waveform including at least one of a metering keep-in section or a metering hold-in section, and wherein a duration of the metering keep-in section is different than a duration of the combustion keep-in section or an amplitude of the metering hold-in section is different than an amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.

(7) In one aspect, a system may include a fuel injector configured to perform fuel injection and fuel metering; and an electronic control module (ECM) configured to: generate a combustion signal to cause the fuel injector to perform the fuel injection to inject at least one of a first fuel or a second fuel into a cylinder of an engine; and generate a metering signal to cause the fuel injector to perform the fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine, wherein the combustion signal includes a combustion waveform including at least one of a combustion keep-in section or a combustion hold-in section, wherein the metering signal includes a metering waveform including at least one of a metering keep-in section or a metering hold-in section, and wherein a duration of the metering keep-in section is different than a duration of the combustion keep-in section or an amplitude of the metering hold-in section is different than an amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate various exemplary embodiments and together with the description, serve to explain the principles of the disclosed embodiments.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an example multi-fuel injection system.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a diagram of an example fuel injector.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a diagram of an ECM.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of an example process for generating a combustion waveform and a metering waveform.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a diagram of an example combustion waveform and a metering waveform having a hold-in section with a reduced amplitude.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a diagram of an example combustion waveform and a metering waveform having a hold-in section with an increased amplitude.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a diagram of an example combustion waveform and a metering waveform having a keep-in section with an increased duration.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (9) Both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory only and are not restrictive of the features, as claimed. As used herein, the terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “has,” “having,” “includes,” “including,” or other variations thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion such that a process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises a list of elements does not include only those elements, but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such a process, method, article, or apparatus. In this disclosure, unless stated otherwise, relative terms, such as, for example, “about,” “substantially,” and “approximately” are used to indicate a possible variation of +10% in the stated value.
- (10) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an example multi-fuel injection system **100**. As shown in FIG. 1, the multi-fuel injection system **100** may include an engine **102**, cylinders **104**, pistons **106**, an engine sensor **108**, a crankshaft **110**, a crankshaft sensor **112**, fuel injectors **114**, a primary fuel reservoir **116**, a primary fuel pump **118**, a pilot fuel reservoir **120**, a pilot fuel pump **122**, a sensor **124**, and an ECM **126**.
- (11) According to an embodiment, the multi-fuel injection system **100** may be provided in heavy equipment or other types of mobile or stationary industrial machines. For example, heavy equipment may include an articulated truck, an asphalt paver, a backhoe loader, a cold planer, a compactor, a dozer, a dragline, a drill, an excavator, a mining shovel, a material handler, a motor grader, a wheel loader, or the like. Other types of suitable industrial machines include stationary or mobile power generation machines, among others. According to an embodiment, the multi-fuel injection system **100** may be provided in a marine power system. For example, a marine power system may include a propulsion engine, a marine generator, an auxiliary engine, or the like. In other examples, the multi-fuel injection system **100** may be provided in an oil and gas system. The oil and gas system may include a power grid stabilization system, a gas compression engine, a land drilling engine, a land drilling generator, a land production generator, an offshore drilling and production generator, a well service engine, or the like. Alternatively, the multi-fuel injection system **100** may be provided in an industrial power system. For example, the industrial power system may include an industrial diesel engine, an industrial diesel power unit, a diesel fire pump, or the like.
- (12) The engine **102** may include one or more cylinders **104**. The engine **102** may include an engine sensor **108** that is configured to output engine sensor data. The engine sensor data may include a heat value of the engine **102**, a heat value of a cylinder **104**, a pressure value of a cylinder

104, a speed of the engine **102**, or the like. Each cylinder **104** may include a piston **106** that is connected to a crankshaft **110**. The piston **106** may travel between top dead center and bottom dead center to rotate the crankshaft **110**. The crankshaft sensor **112** is configured to output crankshaft sensor data. The crankshaft sensor data may indicate a rotation angle of the crankshaft **110**, a rotational speed of the crankshaft **110**, or the like. Each cylinder **104** may include a corresponding fuel injector **114** that is configured to inject fuel into the cylinder **104**.

(13) The primary fuel reservoir **116** may store a primary fuel. The primary fuel pump **118** may pump the primary fuel from the primary fuel reservoir **116** to respective fuel injectors **114**. The pilot fuel reservoir **120** may store a pilot fuel. The pilot fuel pump **122** may pump the pilot fuel to respective fuel injectors **114**. The fuel injector **114** may be configured to inject the primary fuel and the pilot fuel into the cylinder **104**. According to an embodiment, the primary fuel may be methanol, and the pilot fuel may be diesel. Alternatively, the primary fuel may be ethanol (e.g., E85), biodiesel, biogas, hydrogenated vegetable oil, or the like, and the pilot fuel may be dimethyl ether, Fischer-Tropsch fuel, or the like. For a single combustion cycle, the fuel injector **114** may inject a total amount of fuel into the cylinder **104**. The total amount of fuel may include an amount of the primary fuel and an amount of the pilot fuel. A percentage of the amount of the primary fuel to the total amount of fuel may be greater than or equal to a threshold (e.g., 50%, 60%, or the like). Further, a percentage of the pilot fuel to the total amount of fuel may be less than or equal to the threshold. For each combustion cycle, the fuel injector **114** may inject the pilot fuel entirely before the primary fuel, may inject the pilot fuel substantially before the primary fuel, or the like.

(14) The sensor **124** may be configured to output sensor data to the ECM **126**. For example, the sensor data may indicate a gas pedal position, a brake pedal position, a lever position, a geographical position, a temperature, a pressure, a speed, an acceleration, a maintenance status, a fuel amount, or the like.

(15) The ECM **126** may be configured to generate a combustion signal having a combustion waveform. The combustion signal may cause fuel injection by the fuel injector **114**. The ECM **126** may be configured to generate a metering signal having a metering waveform. The ECM **126** may cause fuel metering of the fuel injector **114**.

(16) Although FIG. 1 depicts particular components, a particular arrangement of the components, and a particular number of the components, it should be understood that other embodiments may include different components, a different arrangement of components, and/or a different number of components.

(17) FIG. 2 is a diagram of an example fuel injector **114**. As shown in FIG. 2, the fuel injector **114** may include a plunger **202**, a chamber **204**, a spill valve **206**, a spill valve member **208**, a spill valve solenoid **210**, a spill valve armature **212**, a control valve **214**, a control valve member **216**, a control valve solenoid **218**, a control valve armature **220**, a control chamber **222**, a one-way valve **224**, an injection valve **226**, an injection valve member **228**, an injection valve fill passage **230**, an injection valve passage **232**, a nozzle **234**, a nozzle chamber **236**, an orifice **238**, a pilot fuel opening **240**, a pilot fuel supply connection **242**, a low-pressure fuel passage **244**, a pressurized fuel passage **246**, and a radial fuel passage **248**.

(18) The spill valve **206** may include the spill valve member **208** that is movable between an open position and a closed position. The spill valve solenoid **210** may actuate the spill valve member **208** between the open position and the closed position via the spill valve armature **212**. In the open position, the spill valve member **208** may enable primary fuel within the pressurized fuel passage **246** to drain. In the closed position, the spill valve member **208** may prevent draining of the primary fuel, which permits pressurization of the primary fuel via movement of the plunger **202** within the chamber **204**.

(19) The control valve **214** may include the control valve member **216** that is movable between a non-injection position and an injection position. The control valve solenoid **218** may actuate the control valve member **216** between the non-injection position and the injection position via the

control valve armature **220**. In the non-injection position, the control valve member **216** may block a connection between the low-pressure fuel passage **244** and the control chamber **222**. In the injection position, the control valve member **216** may connect the low-pressure fuel passage **244** and the control chamber **222**. The control valve **214** may be configured to control the introduction of pilot fuel into the injection valve **226**. In the injection position, the control valve member **216** may permit the control chamber **222** to provide pilot fuel to the injection valve **226**.

(20) The control valve **214** may include the control valve member **216** that is movable between a metering position and a non-metering position, which may correspond to the injection position and the non-injection position, respectively. The control valve solenoid **218** may actuate the control valve member **216** between the metering position and the non-metering position via the control valve armature **220**. The control valve **214** may be configured to perform fuel metering by supplying the pilot fuel into the nozzle **234** when the fuel injector **114** is not performing fuel injection. The control valve **214** may be actuated for a period of time prior to fuel injection to cause the pilot fuel to flow from the pilot fuel supply connection **242** to the low-pressure fuel passage **244**. The control valve member **216** may permit the pilot fuel to pass the one-way valve **224** and enter into the injection valve fill passage **230**, the radial fuel passage **248**, the injection valve member **228**, and the pilot fuel opening **240**.

(21) The control valve member **216** may be configured to over-travel. For instance, if the control valve member **216** is provided with a first signal having a first amplitude, then the control valve member **216** may be actuated by a first amount measured from a distal end of the control valve member **216** from a valve seat surface. Further, if the control valve member **216** is provided with a second signal having a second amplitude that is greater than the first amplitude, then the control valve member **216** may be actuated by a second amount that is greater than the first amount. The difference between the first amount and the second amount (e.g., an increased distance that valve member **216** moves away from the valve seat against a spring in the fuel injector **114**) may constitute over-travel of the control valve member **216**.

(22) The injection valve **226** may include the injection valve member **228** that is movable between a non-injection position and an injection position. In the non-injection position, the injection valve member **228** may block the orifice **238** of the nozzle **234**. In the injection position, the injection valve member **228** may un-block the orifice **238** to allow fuel injection of the primary fuel and/or the pilot fuel from the nozzle chamber **236**.

(23) The injection valve member **228** may have a needle-like shape that extends from a proximal end abutting the control chamber **222** to a distal end that blocks and unblocks the orifice **238**. The injection valve member **228** may have a hollow interior that defines the injection valve passage **232**. The injection valve passage **232** may be configured to guide pilot fuel to the distal end of the nozzle chamber **236** of the nozzle **234** and, if desired, store a quantity of the pilot fuel in the hollow interior. The hollow interior may extend from a central portion of the injection valve member **228** that abuts the injection valve fill passage **230** to the distal end of the injection valve member **228** within the nozzle chamber **236**. The proximal portion of the injection valve passage **232** may include the radial fuel passage **248** in a central portion of the injection valve passage **232** that is in fluid communication with the injection valve fill passage **230**. The injection valve passage **232** may include the pilot fuel opening at, or near, the distal end of the injection valve **226**. The pilot fuel opening may open into the nozzle chamber **236** within the nozzle **234**. The injection valve fill passage **230** may include the one-way valve **224** that allows flow of fuel from the control chamber **222** to the radial fuel passage **248**, and prevents the fuel from returning to the control chamber **222** via the injection valve fill passage **230**.

(24) The fuel injector **114** may receive the primary fuel from the primary fuel reservoir **116**. The fuel injector may **114** include a primary fuel path including the chamber **204**, the pressurized fuel passage **246**, the nozzle chamber **236**, and the nozzle **234**. The primary fuel path may also include the spill valve **206**. The spill valve **206** may be configured to pressurize the primary fuel within the

fuel injector **114**, and drain the primary fuel from the fuel injector **114**.

(25) The fuel injector **114** may receive the pilot fuel from the pilot fuel reservoir **120**. The fuel injector **114** may include a pilot fuel path. The pilot fuel path may include the pilot fuel supply connection **242**, the low-pressure fuel passage **244**, the injection valve fill passage **230**, the control chamber **222**, the injection valve passage **232** formed within a hollow interior of the injection valve **226** that includes the radial fuel passage **248**, the pilot fuel opening **240**, and the nozzle **234**.

(26) FIG. **3** is a diagram of an example ECM **126**. As shown in FIG. **3**, the ECM **126** may include a processor **302**, a memory **304**, a combustion signal generator **306**, and a metering signal generator **308**.

(27) The processor **302** may be a central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU), an accelerated processing unit (APU), a microprocessor, a controller, a microcontroller, a digital signal processor (DSP), a field-programmable gate array (FPGA), an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or the like. The processor **302** may be implemented in hardware, firmware, or a combination of hardware and software. The processor **302** may include one or more processors **302** configured to perform the operations described herein. For example, a single processor **302** may be configured to perform all of the operations described herein. Alternatively, multiple processors **302**, collectively, may be configured to perform all of the operations described herein, and each of the multiple processors **302** may be configured to perform a subset of the operations described herein. For example, a first processor **302** may perform a first subset of the operations described herein, a second processor **302** may be configured to perform a second subset of the operations described herein, etc.

(28) The memory **304** may be configured to store information and/or instructions for use by the processor **302**. The memory **304** may be a non-transitory computer-readable medium. For example, the memory **304** may be a random access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), a flash memory, a magnetic memory, an optical memory, or the like. The memory **304** may be configured to store instructions that, when executed by the processor **302**, cause the processor **302** to perform the operations described herein. The memory **304** may include maps, look-up tables, functional relationships, or the like, that allow the processor **302** to set and monitor the fuel injection window, the reload windows, and/or the fuel metering window.

(29) The combustion signal generator **306** may generate the combustion signal **310** which causes the control valve solenoid **218** to actuate the control valve member **216**, via the control valve armature **220**, to the injection position. The fuel injection may include the injection of primary fuel and/or pilot fuel by the fuel injector **114** into the cylinder **104**. The combustion signal **310** may have a combustion waveform. For example, the combustion waveform may represent an amplitude of the combustion signal **310** versus time. The combustion waveform may have a combustion pull-in section, a combustion keep-in section, and/or a combustion hold-in section. The combustion pull-in section may have a current level that causes the control valve member **216** to start moving and reach the fully-actuated position. The combustion keep-in section may have a current level that is less than the combustion pull-in section and that prevents return of the control valve member **216**. The combustion keep-in section may have a minimum or reduced current to minimize delay between when current drops to zero and when the control valve member **216** actually reaches the resting position. Although the combustion waveform is described herein as including particular sections and a particular number of sections, it should be understood that other embodiments may include combustion waveforms including any particular sections and any number of sections (e.g., a single section, two sections, three sections, four sections, etc.). In configurations with four sections, the sections may include a pull-in section, a keep-in section, a hold-in section, and a battery-power section. The battery-power section may have an amplitude that is similar to that of the hold-in section.

(30) The metering signal generator **308** may generate the metering signal **312** which causes the control valve solenoid **218** to actuate the control valve member **216**, via the control valve armature

220, to the metering position. The fuel metering may include the introduction of the pilot fuel from the low-pressure fuel passage **244** into the nozzle **234** via the injection valve fill passage **230** while the fuel injector **114** is not injecting fuel into the cylinder **104**. The metering signal **312** may have a metering waveform. For example, the metering waveform may represent an amplitude of the metering signal versus time. The metering waveform may have a metering pull-in section, a metering keep-in section, and/or a metering hold-in section. The metering pull-in section may have a current level that causes the control valve member **216** to start moving and reach the fully-actuated position. The metering keep-in section may have a current level that is less than the metering pull-in section and that prevents return of the control valve member **216**. The metering keep-in section may have a minimum or reduced current to minimize delay between when current drops to zero and when the control valve member **216** actually reaches the resting position. Although the metering waveform is described herein as including particular sections and a particular number of sections, it should be understood that other embodiments may include metering waveforms including any particular sections and any number of sections (e.g., a single section, two sections, three sections, four sections, etc.).

(31) The ECM **126** may be configured to generate the combustion signal and/or the metering signal based on predetermined information. Additionally, or alternatively, the ECM **126** may be configured to generate the combustion signal and/or the metering signal based on engine sensor data received from the engine sensor **108**, crankshaft sensor data received from the crankshaft sensor **112**, and/or sensor data received from the sensor **124**.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(32) FIG. **4** is a flowchart of an example process **400** for generating a combustion signal having a combustion waveform and a metering signal having a metering waveform.

(33) As shown in FIG. **4**, the process **400** may include receiving first fuel (operation **402**). For example, the multi-fuel injection system **100** may receive first fuel. The first fuel may be primary fuel. The primary fuel may be a fuel with a low cetane rating. For example, the cetane rating of the primary fuel may be less than a threshold (e.g., 20, 10, etc.). As a particular example, the primary fuel may be methanol.

(34) As further shown in FIG. **4**, the process **400** may include receiving second fuel (operation **404**). For example, the multi-fuel injection system **100** may receive second fuel. The second fuel may be pilot fuel. The pilot fuel may be a fuel with a higher cetane rating than the primary fuel. For example, the cetane rating of the pilot fuel may be greater than a threshold (e.g., 20, 10, etc.). As a particular example, the pilot fuel may be diesel.

(35) As further shown in FIG. **4**, the process **400** may include generating a combustion signal having a combustion waveform to cause a fuel injector to perform fuel injection to inject the first fuel and/or the second fuel into a cylinder of the engine (operation **406**). For example, the ECM **126** may generate a combustion signal **310** having a combustion waveform which causes the fuel injector **114** to perform fuel injection to inject the first fuel and/or the second fuel into the cylinder **104** of the engine **102** by the fuel injector **114**. As a particular example, the ECM **126** may generate the combustion signal **310** which causes the control valve solenoid **218** to actuate the control valve member **216** to the injection position. The fuel injection may include the injection of the first fuel (e.g., primary fuel) and/or the second fuel (e.g., pilot fuel) by the fuel injector **114** into the cylinder **104**.

(36) The combustion signal **310** may have a combustion waveform. For example, the combustion waveform may represent an amplitude of the combustion signal **310** versus time. The combustion waveform may have a combustion pull-in section, a combustion hold-in section, and/or a combustion keep-in section.

(37) As an example, and as shown in FIG. **5**, the ECM **126** may generate a combustion signal having a combustion waveform **502**. The combustion waveform **502** may include a combustion pull-in section **504** that has a duration that extends from a time T1 to a time T2 and that includes an

amplitude A5, a combustion keep-in section **506** that has a duration that extends from a time T2 to a time T3 and that includes an amplitude A4, and a combustion hold-in section **508** that has a duration that extends from a time T3 to a time T4 and that includes an amplitude A3. The illustrated amplitudes may represent the average current or target current for each section. The current (e.g., pull-in, keep-in, and/or hold-in sections) may be a chopped waveform in which the current regularly repeats between a maximum value and a minimum value that are slightly greater than and slightly less than the average value, respectively.

(38) As another example, and as shown in FIG. 6, the ECM **126** may generate a combustion signal having a combustion waveform **602**. The combustion waveform **602** may include a combustion pull-in section **604** that has a duration that extends from a time T1 to a time T2 and that includes an amplitude A5, a combustion keep-in section **606** that has a duration that extends from a time T2 to a time T3 and that includes an amplitude A3, and a combustion hold-in section **608** that has a duration that extends from a time T3 to a time T4 and that includes an amplitude A2.

(39) As another example, and as shown in FIG. 7, the ECM **126** may generate a combustion signal having a combustion waveform **702**. The combustion waveform **702** may include a combustion pull-in section **704** that has a duration that extends from a time T1 to a time T2 and that includes an amplitude A4, a combustion keep-in section **706** that has a duration that extends from a time T2 to a time T3 and that includes an amplitude A3, and a combustion hold-in section **708** that has a duration that extends from a time T3 to a time T4 and that includes an amplitude A2.

(40) As further shown in FIG. 4, the process **400** may include generating a metering signal having a metering waveform to cause the fuel injector to perform fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine (operation **408**). For example, the ECM **126** may generate a metering signal **312** having a metering waveform to cause the fuel injector **114** to perform fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into the nozzle **234** of the fuel injector **114** while the fuel injector **114** is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder **104** of the engine **102**. As a particular example, the ECM **126** may generate the metering signal to cause the control valve solenoid **218** to actuate the control valve member **216**, via the control valve armature **220**, to the metering position. The fuel metering may include the introduction of the pilot fuel from the low-pressure fuel passage **244** into the nozzle **234** via the injection valve fill passage **230** while the fuel injector **114** is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder **104**.

(41) The metering signal **308** may have a metering waveform. For example, the metering waveform may represent an amplitude of the metering signal **312** versus time. The metering waveform may have a metering pull-in section, a metering keep-in section, and/or a metering hold-in section. The metering waveform may have one or more sections that have different durations and/or amplitudes as compared to corresponding one or more sections of the combustion waveform.

(42) As shown in FIG. 5, the ECM **126** may generate a metering signal having a metering waveform **510**. The metering waveform **510** may include a metering pull-in section **512** that has a duration that extends from a time T5 to a time T6 and that includes an amplitude A5, a metering keep-in section **514** that has a duration that extends from a time T6 to a time T7 and that includes an amplitude A4, and a metering hold-in section **516** that has a duration that extends from a time T7 to a time T8 and that includes an amplitude A2. As shown, the metering hold-in section **516** has a duration (T7-T8) that is greater than a duration (T3-T4) of the combustion hold-in section **508**. Further, the metering hold-in section **516** has an amplitude (A2) that is less than an amplitude (A3) of the combustion hold-in section **508**. The reduced amplitude A2 of the metering hold-in section **516** may facilitate sufficient flow of the pilot fuel to the nozzle **234** while preventing overheating of the control valve solenoid **218**. In some aspects, metering hold-in section **516** may correspond to a period of time at which the pressure of the primary fuel within fuel injector **114** (e.g., in nozzle chamber **236** and/or in pressurized fuel passage **246**) is relatively low.

(43) As shown in FIG. 6, the ECM 126 may generate a metering signal having a metering waveform 610. The metering waveform 610 may include a metering pull-in section 612 that has a duration that extends from a time T5 to a time T6 and that includes an amplitude A5, and a metering hold-in section 614 that has a duration that extends from a time T6 to a time T7 and that includes an amplitude A4. As shown, the metering hold-in section 614 has a duration (T6-T8) that is greater than a duration (T3-T4) of the combustion hold-in section 608. Further, the metering hold-in section 614 has an amplitude (A4) that is greater than an amplitude (A2) of the combustion hold-in section 608. The increased amplitude A4 of the metering hold-in section 614 may cause over-travel of the control valve member 216 which may result in greater flow of the pilot fuel through the control valve 214 and which also may result in a reduced duration of the fuel metering as compared to situations in which over-travel is not caused.

(44) As shown in FIG. 7, the ECM 126 may generate a metering signal having a metering waveform 710. The metering waveform 710 may include a metering pull-in section 712 that has a duration that extends from a time T5 to a time T6 and that includes an amplitude A5, a metering keep-in section 714 that has a duration that extends from a time T6 to a time T7 and that includes an amplitude A3, and a metering hold-in section 716 that has a duration that extends from a time T7 to a time T8 and that includes an amplitude A2. As shown, the metering keep-in section 714 has a duration (T6-T7) that is greater than a duration (T2-T3) of the combustion keep-in section 706. The longer keep-in section 714 may ensure the control valve 214 remains in the energized position while the control valve 214 may be perturbed by an external force, such as the fluid forces induced by the plunger 202 returning to an upward-most position.

(45) The amplitudes A1, A2, A3, A4, and/or A5 in FIG. 5 may be the same as, or different than, the amplitudes A1, A2, A3, A4, and/or A5 in FIG. 6 and/or the amplitudes A1, A2, A3, and/or A4 in FIG. 7. Further, the times T1, T2, T3, T4, T5, T6, T7, and/or T8 in FIG. 5 may be the same as, or different than, the times T1, T2, T3, T4, T5, T6, and/or T7 in FIG. 6 and/or the times T1, T2, T3, T4, T5, T6, T7, and/or T8 in FIG. 7.

(46) The ECM 126 may be configured to generate a metering waveform that has a metering pull-in section, a metering keep-in section, and/or a metering hold-in section based on preconfigured information, based on engine sensor data received from the engine sensor 108, based on crankshaft sensor data received from the crankshaft sensor 112, and/or based on sensor data received from the sensor 124. For example, the ECM 126 may select, or modify, the respective durations and/or amplitudes of the metering pull-in section, the metering keep-in section, and/or the metering hold-in section.

(47) The disclosed aspects of the system and method for generating a combustion signal having a combustion waveform and a metering signal having a metering waveform may be used in conjunction with any appropriate machine, vehicle, or other device or system that includes an engine having a fuel injector that is configured to perform fuel injection and fuel metering. In particular the system and method may be used in any heavy equipment, marine power system, oil and gas system, industrial power system, or the like, in which an ECM may generate a metering signal having a metering waveform that is asymmetrical to a combustion waveform of a combustion signal. The disclosed aspects may provide faster metering, reduced solenoid temps, ability to adapt metering for particular conditions, or the like.

(48) It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the disclosed system and method without departing from the scope of the disclosure. Other embodiments of the system will be apparent to those skilled in the art from consideration of the specification and practice of the system and method disclosed herein. It is intended that the specification and examples be considered as exemplary only, with a true scope of the disclosure being indicated by the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A method comprising: receiving, by a multi-fuel injection system, a first fuel; receiving, by the multi-fuel injection system, a second fuel; generating, by the multi-fuel injection system, a combustion signal to cause a fuel injector to perform fuel injection to inject at least one of the first fuel or the second fuel into a cylinder of an engine; and generating, by the multi-fuel injection system, a metering signal to cause the fuel injector to perform fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine, wherein the combustion signal includes a combustion waveform including at least one of a combustion keep-in section or a combustion hold-in section, wherein the metering signal includes a metering waveform including at least one of a metering keep-in section or a metering hold-in section, and wherein a duration of the metering keep-in section is different than a duration of the combustion keep-in section or an amplitude of the metering hold-in section is different than an amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the duration of the metering hold-in section is greater than the duration of the combustion hold-in section.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the amplitude of the metering hold-in section is less than the amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the amplitude of the metering hold-in section is greater than the amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion keep-in section, the metering signal includes the metering keep-in section, and the duration of the metering keep-in section is greater than the duration of the combustion keep-in section.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the first fuel is a primary fuel, and the second fuel is a pilot fuel.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the first fuel has a lower cetane rating than the second fuel.
8. An electronic control module (ECM) comprising: a memory configured to store instructions; and one or more processors configured to execute the instructions to: generate a combustion signal to cause a fuel injector to perform fuel injection to inject at least one of a first fuel or a second fuel into a cylinder of an engine; and generate a metering signal to cause the fuel injector to perform fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine, wherein the combustion signal includes a combustion waveform including at least one of a combustion keep-in section or a combustion hold-in section, wherein the metering signal includes a metering waveform including at least one of a metering keep-in section or a metering hold-in section, and wherein a duration of the metering keep-in section is different than a duration of the combustion keep-in section or an amplitude of the metering hold-in section is different than an amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
9. The ECM of claim 8, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the duration of the metering hold-in section is greater than the duration of the combustion hold-in section.
10. The ECM of claim 8, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the amplitude of the metering hold-in section is less than the amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
11. The ECM of claim 8, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the amplitude of the metering hold-in section is greater than the amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.

12. The ECM of claim 8, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion keep-in section, the metering signal includes the metering keep-in section, and the duration of the metering keep-in section is greater than the duration of the combustion keep-in section.
 13. The ECM of claim 8, wherein the metering signal causes over-travel of the fuel injector.
 14. The ECM of claim 8, wherein the ECM is configured to generate the metering signal based on engine sensor data received from an engine sensor, crankshaft sensor data received from a crankshaft sensor, or sensor data received from a sensor.
 15. A system comprising: a fuel injector configured to perform fuel injection and fuel metering; and an electronic control module (ECM) configured to: generate a combustion signal to cause the fuel injector to perform the fuel injection to inject at least one of a first fuel or a second fuel into a cylinder of an engine; and generate a metering signal to cause the fuel injector to perform the fuel metering to introduce the second fuel into a nozzle of the fuel injector while the fuel injector is not injecting either of the first fuel or the second fuel into the cylinder of the engine, wherein the combustion signal includes a combustion waveform including at least one of a combustion keep-in section or a combustion hold-in section, wherein the metering signal includes a metering waveform including at least one of a metering keep-in section or a metering hold-in section, and wherein a duration of the metering keep-in section is different than a duration of the combustion keep-in section or an amplitude of the metering hold-in section is different than an amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
 16. The system of claim 15, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the duration of the metering hold-in section is greater than the duration of the combustion hold-in section.
 17. The system of claim 15, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the amplitude of the metering hold-in section is less than the amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
 18. The system of claim 15, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion hold-in section, the metering signal includes the metering hold-in section, and the amplitude of the metering hold-in section is greater than the amplitude of the combustion hold-in section.
 19. The system of claim 15, wherein the combustion signal includes the combustion keep-in section, the metering signal includes the metering keep-in section, and the duration of the metering keep-in section is greater than the duration of the combustion keep-in section.
 20. The system of claim 15, wherein the first fuel is a primary fuel, and the second fuel is a pilot fuel.
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